Aoran Zhang

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Machine learning for complex and high-dimensional data, with interests in reliable and scalable learning, representation and generative models, and computational methods for scientific applications.

EDUCATION

Rice University Aug 2025 - Present

Ph.D. in Electrical and Computer Engineering (AI & Systems); Advisor: *Cesar A. Uribe*

Carnegie Mellon University Aug 2021 - May 2025

B.S. in Statistics and Machine Learning; Additional Major in Artificial Intelligence

PUBLICATIONS & PREPRINTS

1. **Aoran Zhang** and Cesar A. Uribe, "Adaptive Bregman Alternating Projections for Feasible Gromov-Wasserstein Learning." *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.04264, 2026*.
   Workshop papers accepted to Geometric Distributional Deep Learning (GDDL) and Optimization for Machine Learning (OPT), NeurIPS 2026.
2. **Aoran Zhang**, Tianyao Wei, Maria J. Guerrero, and Cesar A. Uribe, "Sparse Network Inference under Imperfect Detection and its Application to Ecological Networks." *arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.18820, 2026*.
   Workshop paper accepted to TCCL, NeurIPS 2026.
3. **Aoran Zhang**, Wenbin Zhou, Liyan Xie, and Shixiang Zhu, "Recurrent Neural Goodness-of-Fit Test for Time Series." *Proceedings of the 28th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS), PMLR 258:2917-2925, 2025*.
4. **Aoran Zhang**, Marit F. L. Ruitenberg, Matthew Warburton, Stephen Scott, and Jonathan S. Tsay, "Large Reaching Datasets Quantify the Impact of Age, Sex/Gender, and Experience on Motor Control." *Communications Psychology 4, 16 (2026)*.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

Adaptive Bregman Alternating Projections for Feasible Gromov-Wasserstein Learning.

SIAM Conference on Imaging Science (IS26), accepted presentation, 2026.

Sparse Network Inference under Imperfect Detection and Its Application to Ecological Networks.

MOPTA 2026; SIAM Conference on Mathematics of Data Science (MDS26), accepted presentation, 2026.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROGRAMS & WORKSHOPS

Selected Participant, *ICERM Topical Workshop: Asynchronous Methods for Numerical Linear Algebra*, Institute for Computational and Experimental Research in Mathematics (ICERM), Brown University, Providence, RI, May 4-8, 2026.

AWARDS & PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ken Kennedy Institute Computational Science and Engineering Recruiting Fellowship	2025-2029
Undergraduate Honors Thesis Program, Carnegie Mellon University	2024-2025
INFORMS DEI Ambassador Program Travel Grant	2024
Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship, Carnegie Mellon University	2024
Session Chair, INFORMS Data Mining and Decision Analytics Workshop	2024